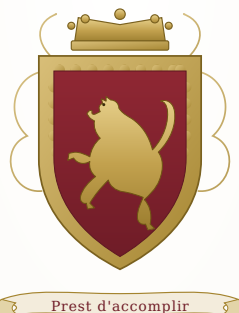


A BIOGRAPHICAL DOSSIER



Gerald Francis Talbot

Commander · K.C.V.O., C.M.G., O.B.E., R.N.V.R.

1881 — 1945

Naval officer and intelligence hand
Britain's secret emissary to revolutionary Athens
The man who saved Prince Andrew of Greece —
and the infant Prince Philip — from the firing squad

PREPARED FOR EDWARD HAWKE

great-grandson of the subject · The Hawke Family Archive · MMXXVI

Contents

- I. **The Man in Brief**
 Vital statistics and a portrait in a paragraph
- II. **An Ancient Name — The House of Talbot**
 From the English Achilles to a Staffordshire rectory
- III. **Early Life & the Road to Athens**
 Birth, family, and a curious path into the Navy
- IV. **“A Sort of Spy” — The Intelligence Officer**
 What the record really shows about the legend
- V. **The Rescue of Prince Andrew**
 December 1922: a prince, a warship, and an orange box
- VI. **Rescued “From the Germans”?**
 A treasured family memory, examined with care
- VII. **The Quiet Decades, Marriage & Death**
 Lady Talbot, a Paris-Bradford marriage, and the long silence
- VIII. **The Line to the Present**
 The descent from Gerald down to you
- IX. **A Life in Brief — Chronology**
 The whole life on a single ladder of dates
- X. **Honours, Arms & Family Seats**
 The decorations, the heraldry, the houses
- XI. **Sources & Method**
 How this dossier was built, and what remains open

SECTION ONE

The Man in Brief

Commander Sir Gerald Francis Talbot was a sailor who never had a conventional naval career, a diplomat who never joined the Foreign Office, and a man whose single most consequential act was carried out quietly, in secret, and on someone else's behalf. In December 1922 he walked into a capital city ruled by a revolutionary tribunal that had just shot six former ministers, and he walked out again with a prince of Greece — and that prince's eighteen-month-old son, the future Prince Philip, Duke of Edinburgh. For this he was knighted by King George V within a fortnight. He then all but vanished from the public record for the remaining twenty-three years of his life.

He was a member of one of England's most storied families, the Talbots, cousins to the Earls of Shrewsbury and descended — through a younger branch — from the medieval warrior John Talbot, "the English Achilles." He spoke the language of European drawing-rooms and revolutionary committees alike. Contemporaries called him a spy; the truth is more interesting and more precise. This dossier sets out what can be firmly established about his life, distinguishes it from family legend, and follows his bloodline both back to the fifteenth century and forward to the present generation.

VITAL STATISTICS

FULL NAME & STYLE	Commander Sir Gerald Francis Talbot, K.C.V.O., C.M.G., O.B.E., R.N.V.R.
BORN	21 August 1881 (England; exact parish not yet confirmed)
DIED	17 April 1945, aged 63
FAMILY	Chetwynd-Talbot — cadet branch of the Earls of Shrewsbury / Earls Talbot of Ingestre
SERVICE	Royal Naval Volunteer Reserve; Acting Commander from 23 Aug 1917
PRINCIPAL POST	Naval Attaché to H.M. Legation, Athens (from 1917)
FAMOUS FOR	The secret rescue of Prince Andrew of Greece & Denmark, December 1922
HONOURS	O.B.E. (1919) · C.M.G. (1920) · K.C.V.O. (14 Dec 1922)
WIFE	Hélène Jarislowsky (m. 15 June 1920; d. 1975)
CHILD	Isobel Helen Henrietta Talbot (b. 1923)
RELATIONSHIP TO YOU	Great-grandfather of Edward Hawke

“He saved not one life but a dynasty’s future, and asked for nothing.”

SECTION TWO

An Ancient Name — The House of Talbot

To understand Gerald Talbot, begin with his name. The Talbots are among the oldest surviving aristocratic houses in England, traceable in the records to a Norman tenant in the Domesday Book of 1086. Over the following centuries the family produced barons, earls, a Lord High Chancellor, and one of the most celebrated soldiers of the Middle Ages. Gerald belonged to a younger — or “cadet” — branch of this house: not in line for the great titles, but unquestionably of the blood.

The English Achilles

The towering figure of the family is **John Talbot, 1st Earl of Shrewsbury** (c. 1387–1453), the dominant English commander of the closing decades of the Hundred Years' War. So feared was he in France that he was nicknamed "the English Achilles," and Shakespeare gave him a hero's death in *Henry VI, Part 1*. He was in fact killed in the field at the **Battle of Castillon** on 17 July 1453 — the last great battle of the war — with his son dying at his side. From this man, through a documented chain of generations, Gerald Talbot was descended.

THE CADET BRANCH

Gerald's line ran from the 1st Earl, through the 2nd Earl's third son **Sir Gilbert Talbot** (1452–1518), who commanded a wing of Henry Tudor's army at Bosworth in 1485. Sir Gilbert's descendants produced **Charles Talbot, 1st Baron Talbot of Hensol** (1685–1737), Lord High Chancellor of Great Britain, and from him the **Earls Talbot of Ingestre**. Gerald's grandfather, the Rev. Hon. William Whitworth Chetwynd-Talbot, was a younger son of the 2nd Earl Talbot.

In 1856 the senior line of this same family, under Gerald's great-great-uncle Henry John Chetwynd-Talbot, inherited the premier earldom of England and became the **18th Earl of Shrewsbury** — reuniting the names of Talbot and Shrewsbury. Gerald was therefore a cousin of the Earls of Shrewsbury; the present (22nd) Earl is his fourth cousin. The family seats were the great Staffordshire houses of **Ingestre Hall** — where Gerald's grandfather and father were both born — and **Alton Towers**, today better known as a pleasure-ground than a peer's palace.

The line, generation by generation

The descent below is firmly documented from the seventeenth century onward, and well-attested across the major peerage references for the medieval generations. One link — a sixteenth-century step around "John of Salwarpe" — rests on genealogical compilations rather than original documents, and is flagged accordingly.

John Talbot, 1st Earl of Shrewsbury c. 1387–1453

"The English Achilles"; killed at the Battle of Castillon



John Talbot, 2nd Earl of Shrewsbury c. 1413–1460

Killed at the Battle of Northampton



Sir Gilbert Talbot, K.G. 1452–1518

Third son; commander at Bosworth Field, 1485

. . . the Grafton & Salwarpe Talbots . . .

Rt. Rev. William Talbot 1659-1730

Bishop of Oxford, Salisbury & Durham

**Charles Talbot, 1st Baron Talbot of Hensol** 1685-1737

Lord High Chancellor of Great Britain

**John Chetwynd-Talbot, 1st Earl Talbot** 1749-1793

Took the name Chetwynd on inheriting Ingestre Hall

**Charles Chetwynd-Talbot, 2nd Earl Talbot** 1777-1849

Of Ingestre Hall, Staffordshire

**Rev. Hon. William Whitworth Chetwynd-Talbot** 1814-1888

Sixth son; Rector of Bishop's Hatfield — Gerald's grandfather

**Lt.-Col. Gerald Francis Talbot** 1848-1904

Of the 2nd Prussian Dragoon Guards; J.P. — Gerald's father

**Commander Sir Gerald Francis Talbot** 1881-1945

The subject of this dossier

An American grandmother: the Bradhursts

Gerald's blood was not only English. His paternal grandmother by marriage aside, it was his own mother who brought a transatlantic strain into the family: **Henrietta Clarissa Noyes Bradhurst**, of the old New York **Bradhurst** family. The Bradhursts held a 110-acre Manhattan estate, "Pinehurst," in what is now Washington Heights and Harlem; **Bradhurst Avenue** in Harlem still carries their name. Henrietta's great-great-grandfather, Dr Samuel Bradhurst, was a surgeon in the American Revolution and a friend and neighbour of **Alexander Hamilton**, to whom he sold the land for Hamilton's house, the Grange, in 1799.

A CLAIM WORTH GETTING RIGHT

The Bradhursts were Hamilton's friends and neighbours — that is documented. The occasionally-heard idea that the family was descended from or blood-related to Hamilton is not supported by the records and should not be repeated as fact.

The arms

The Talbot achievement blazons as Gules, a lion rampant within a bordure engrailed Or — a gold lion on a red field, ringed by a scalloped gold border. The arms are, fittingly for so old a house, a marriage trophy: they were originally the arms of **Gwenllian ferch Rhys Mechyll**, daughter of a thirteenth-century Welsh prince, whom a Talbot married around 1274. Two white **talbot hounds** — the heavy-jowled hunting dog to which the family gave (or from which it took) its name — support the shield, and the motto reads *Prest d’accomplir*: “Ready to accomplish.”

SECTION THREE

Early Life & the Road to Athens

Gerald Francis Talbot was born on 21 August 1881, the fifth of six children of **Lieutenant-Colonel Gerald Francis Talbot** (1848–1904) and his American wife, Henrietta Bradhurst. His was a household steeped in soldiering and in the wider continent: remarkably, his father had served as a young officer in the **2nd Prussian Dragoon Guards** and had written a study of the organisation of the Prussian army before returning to England to become a Staffordshire yeomanry colonel, a Lieutenant of the City of London, and a Justice of the Peace for Essex and Kent.

A NOTE ON THE RECORD

One genealogical source mistakenly gives Gerald’s birth date as 23 November — in fact his father’s birthday. The correct date, 21 August 1881, is the one carried by the principal peerage references. His exact birthplace has not yet been confirmed from a primary register; the family’s roots lay in Staffordshire (Ingestre), with later connections to Essex and Kent.

The missing years

The decades between Gerald’s birth and the First World War are, frustratingly, the least documented of his life. His schooling and any university are not yet established, and — tellingly — he held a commission not in the regular Royal Navy but in the **Royal Naval Volunteer Reserve**, the branch through which civilians, businessmen and men of independent means came to wartime service. This strongly implies a civilian career before 1914: most likely in commerce, finance, or some occupation that took him abroad.

One clue points firmly toward Greece. A modern scholarly biography of the Greek statesman Eleftherios Venizelos describes Talbot, at the moment of his 1917 appointment, as “**a convinced Venizelist from some years back.**” A British naval officer is not normally a partisan of a particular Greek political faction unless he has

spent real time among Greeks. The likeliest reading is that Gerald had personal or business ties to Greece and the Eastern Mediterranean well before the war — ties that, in 1917, made him exactly the right man for Athens.

Into uniform — and into intelligence

By **23 August 1917** Gerald was an Acting Commander, R.N.V.R., taking up the post of **Naval Attaché at the British Legation in Athens**. He arrived at a moment of high drama: Greece, riven by the “National Schism,” had just seen its pro-German king forced out and had entered the war on the Allied side. For his work over the following two years he was appointed to the **Order of the British Empire (O.B.E.)**, gazetted on 27 May 1919, “for valuable services as Naval Attaché in Greece.” In early 1919 he travelled to the **Paris Peace Conference** in Venizelos’s company, acting as a trusted go-between linking the Greek delegation and the British. A further honour, the **C.M.G.**, followed in 1920.

SECTION FOUR

“A Sort of Spy” — The Intelligence Officer

Gerald Talbot has come down through family memory, and through the few histories that mention him, as a spy. It is worth being precise about what that means, because the precise truth is more credible — and more impressive — than the legend. The honest verdict of this research is that Talbot was not, on the available evidence, a card-carrying officer of the Secret Intelligence Service; he was something subtler: an intelligence-saturated diplomat who, when it mattered, conducted a genuine covert operation.

The case for the spy

- ❖ His post itself was an intelligence post. A wartime Naval Attaché in a contested neutral capital existed precisely to gather and report political and naval intelligence to the Admiralty’s Naval Intelligence Division in London.
- ❖ He served in the most intelligence-soaked theatre of the war. Athens was the base from which the novelist **Compton Mackenzie** had run British counter-espionage for the forerunner of MI6, building a card-index of 24,000 suspects. Talbot stepped into this world as Mackenzie’s era there was ending.
- ❖ His decisive mission in 1922 was, in form and method, a covert operation: he was chosen personally (not through official channels), travelled as a private individual, negotiated in secret with an armed revolutionary regime, and pre-positioned a warship whose own captain was kept in the dark about the purpose of the voyage.

The case for precision

And yet: Talbot does not appear, by name, as an SIS officer in the principal published histories of British intelligence, nor in Compton Mackenzie's detailed Athens memoirs. His volunteer-reserve rank fits a well-connected amateur brought in for regional expertise rather than a career intelligence professional. The most accurate description is therefore something like "an intelligence-adjacent diplomat with genuine covert-operation experience" — a man the British state reached for precisely because he could do quietly what official channels could not.

A DIFFERENT GERALD TALBOT — RULED OUT

Some accounts confuse our subject with the "Major Gerald Talbot" who obtained the notorious Persian tobacco concession from the Shah in 1890. That cannot be the same man: our Gerald was nine years old in 1890. The two are distinct, a generation apart.

"He could do quietly what official channels could not.

— the essence of his usefulness to the Crown

"

SECTION FIVE

The Rescue of Prince Andrew

In the autumn of 1922 the Greek world fell apart. The Greek army had been annihilated in Asia Minor; Smyrna had burned; and a revolutionary committee of colonels, led by Nikolaos Plastiras and Stylianos Gonatas, had seized power and forced the king to abdicate. They wanted someone to blame. On 28 November 1922, after a show trial, they shot six former royalist ministers and a general by firing squad — an act the British government denounced as "judicial murder." And waiting in a prison cell, expecting to be next, was **Prince Andrew of Greece and Denmark**, a serving army corps commander, son of one king and brother of another — and father of an eighteen-month-old boy named Philip.

The King's anxiety

News of Andrew's danger reached London and, crucially, reached **King George V**. The King was haunted by a recent failure: in 1917 he had withdrawn an offer of asylum to his cousin Tsar Nicholas II, who was murdered with his family the following year. As his

biographer put it, the King “didn’t want any more blood on his hands.” He pressed his ministers to act. The Foreign Secretary, Lord Curzon, and Venizelos — then at the Lausanne Conference — settled on the one man who combined personal friendship with the revolutionaries’ circle, fluent knowledge of Athens, and the discretion to act unofficially: his old friend, the former Naval Attaché, Gerald Talbot.

“WHAT A PITY THEY WILL SOON BE ORPHANS”

The threat to Andrew was not theoretical. The revolutionary War Minister, General Pangalos — an old academy contemporary of the prince — is reported to have visited Andrew’s cell, asked how many children he had, and remarked: “Poor things, what a pity they will soon be orphans!”

The mission

Talbot reached Athens on **30 November 1922** — two days too late to save the six. His task now was to ensure there would be no seventh. Working in the “utmost secrecy,” he negotiated directly with the revolutionary leadership — Plastiras, Gonatas, Pangalos and the acting foreign minister Rentis. He extracted a precise, choreographed bargain: Andrew would be tried, found guilty, sentenced to banishment rather than death, and then immediately pardoned and handed into Talbot’s personal custody for removal from the country.

It unfolded exactly as arranged. At the court-martial of **1-3 December 1922**, the prince — charged with disobeying an order during the catastrophic Battle of the Sakarya the previous year — was found guilty, stripped of his rank, and condemned to perpetual banishment. Plastiras granted the promised pardon. Andrew was free, and he was Talbot’s.

The orange box

That night the prince was taken down to **Phaleron Bay** and aboard the British light cruiser **HMS Calypso**, under Captain Herbert Buchanan-Wollaston, where Princess Alice was waiting. The cruiser sailed for Corfu to collect the couple’s five children. The youngest, Prince Philip, not yet two, was carried aboard in a cot the ship’s crew improvised from a wooden **orange box** — the detail that, more than any other, fixed this rescue in royal memory. On **5 December 1922** the Calypso landed the family at Brindisi; they travelled on to Rome and Paris, and into exile.

DRAMATIC CHRONOLOGY — THE NINE DAYS

- ❖ **28 Nov 1922** — The six royalist leaders are executed; London learns Andrew is in mortal danger.
- ❖ **30 Nov 1922** — Talbot arrives in Athens; begins secret talks with the revolutionary committee.
- ❖ **1-3 Dec 1922** — Court-martial: Andrew found guilty, sentenced to banishment, then pardoned to Talbot.
- ❖ **3 Dec 1922** — Andrew boards HMS Calypso at Phaleron Bay; the ship sails for Corfu and the children.
- ❖ **5 Dec 1922** — The family lands at Brindisi, Italy. Prince Philip travels in an orange-box cot.
- ❖ **14 Dec 1922** — King George V personally appoints Talbot K.C.V.O. “for services rendered to Prince Andrew of Greece.”

The knighthood that followed was no routine award. The Royal Victorian Order is the personal gift of the Sovereign, bestowed without the involvement of ministers; it was George V’s own way of saying thank you. Talbot received it within eleven days of the rescue. The British chargé in Athens judged that Talbot’s brief visit had done more than save one prince — it had helped “stave off more executions” and brought the revolutionary government “to its senses.”

SECTION SIX

Rescued “From the Germans”? — A Family Mystery Examined

A treasured strand of the family memory holds that Gerald Talbot rescued Prince Andrew from the Germans. The documented rescue, as we have seen, was from a Greek revolutionary government, in peacetime, with no German involvement of any kind. So where does the “Germans” come from? This is not a slip to be brushed aside; it is worth examining, because the family memory turns out to preserve something true about the politics, even as it scrambles the facts.

The most likely explanation

For the entire decade before 1922, the faction to which Prince Andrew belonged — the Greek **royalists** — were known throughout Britain, France and the Allied press as the pro-German party. The reason was personal and direct: Andrew’s brother, **King Con-**

stantine I, was married to the Kaiser's sister, had been trained in Germany, and was widely believed to be a German sympathiser. When the Allies forced Constantine out in 1917, their own proclamation declared bluntly that "Berlin until now has commanded Athens." Prince Andrew himself was, at one point, accused in the British Parliament of being a German agent.

So the political geometry was almost the inverse of the family memory — Talbot rescued a "pro-German" prince from an anti-German, pro-Allied revolutionary regime — and that is precisely the kind of counter-intuitive complexity that oral history simplifies. Across a generation or two of retelling, "a prince of the pro-German party, rescued from his Greek enemies" becomes, in shorthand, "rescued from the Germans."

Why the memory stuck

Two later facts reinforced the German association in the family mind:

- ❖ **Princess Alice's own heritage.** Andrew's wife was a Battenberg — her father, the British admiral Prince Louis of Battenberg, had been hounded from office in 1914 for his German birth and had anglicised the family name to Mountbatten.
- ❖ **The daughters' marriages.** All four of Prince Philip's sisters — the very children carried to safety on HMS Calypso — later married German princes, three of them with Nazi-era connections. By the Second World War, "Prince Andrew's German family" was a vivid and uncomfortable reality, and the rescue story would most often have been retold against that backdrop.

THE VERDICT

The family lore is literally inexact — there were no Germans in the 1922 rescue — but it is not foolish. It faithfully remembers that the people Gerald saved were the side that the world had branded "German" for ten years. The memory compresses a real and complicated truth into a single, vivid word.

SECTION SEVEN

The Quiet Decades, Marriage & Death

Having done the most dramatic thing of his life, Gerald Talbot did one of the least dramatic things imaginable: he disappeared into private life. The twenty-three years between his knighthood and his death have left almost no public trace — no further official post, no company notices, no obvious second act. It is the silence of a man who had no need to be in the newspapers.

A cosmopolitan marriage

On **15 June 1920**, in the midst of his Athens years, Gerald had married **Hélène Jarislowsky**. Hers was a fittingly international background for so international a man. Her father, **Sigismond Jarislowsky**, was a Paris banker — co-founder of the house of Bénard & Jarislowsky, which helped finance the early Paris Métro. Her mother, **Alice Rose Fulda**, had been born in **Bradford, England**, into the German-Jewish textile community that powered that city's Victorian prosperity. Hélène was thus half-Parisian and half-Yorkshire — and, like her husband, a creature of more than one country. The couple had one child, **Isobel Helen Henrietta Talbot**, born on 12 May 1923.

The war, and the end

When the Second World War came, Gerald was already in his late fifties; he does not appear in the Royal Naval Volunteer Reserve officer lists for 1939–45, and seems to have spent the war as a civilian. He died on **17 April 1945**, aged 63, in the war's final weeks — just before the Greece-shaped century he had moved through gave way to a new one. Lady Talbot outlived him by thirty years, dying in 1975.

STILL TO BE CONFIRMED

The precise place and cause of his death, his last address, and the contents of his estate are not yet established from the probate record; nor has his entry in Who Was Who (which would list his schooling, clubs and pre-war occupation) yet been recovered. These are the most promising next steps for completing the picture — see Sources & Method.

SECTION EIGHT

The Line to the Present

Gerald Talbot had no son, and so the Talbot name did not pass down this branch — but his blood did. His only child, Isobel, married into the Mackenzie Smith family in 1942, and from her the line runs directly down to the present generation, and to you.

Commander Sir Gerald Francis Talbot 1881–1945

m. Hélène Jarislowsky (1920; d. 1975)

Isobel Helen Henrietta Talbot b. 1923

His only child — your grandmother · m. Antony Mackenzie Smith, 1942

Catherine Isobel Mackenzie Smith b. 1957

Their daughter — your mother · m. (Hawke)

Edward Hawke

Great-grandson of Sir Gerald — for whom this dossier was prepared

Isobel's other children — Peter (b.1946), Jane Elizabeth (b.1947) and Duncan John Gerald (b.1951) Mackenzie Smith — carry the same descent from Sir Gerald and, through him, from the Earls of Shrewsbury and from the New York Bradhursts. This dossier deliberately keeps the detail of living relatives to the documented public record; the family itself holds the fuller, more personal story below this line.

WHAT YOU INHERIT, ON PAPER

Through this single unbroken line you stand in documented descent from John Talbot, 1st Earl of Shrewsbury (d. 1453); from a Lord High Chancellor of Great Britain; from a Revolutionary-era New York family whose name still marks a Harlem avenue; and from the man who carried a future British prince consort to safety in an orange box.

SECTION NINE

A Life in Brief — Chronology

- 1881** ● **21 August** — Born, fifth of six children of Lt.-Col. Gerald Francis Talbot and Henrietta Bradhurst.
- 1904** ● His father, Lt.-Col. Talbot, dies.
- c.** ● Pre-war career (not yet documented); develops his deep connection to Greece
- 1905** — later called “a convinced Venizelist from some years back.”
- 14**
- 1917** ● **23 August** — Appointed Acting Commander, R.N.V.R., and Naval Attaché at the British Legation, Athens.
- 1919** ● Accompanies Venizelos to the Paris Peace Conference as a British go-between. **27 May** — Appointed O.B.E. for services as Naval Attaché in Greece.
- 1920** ● **15 June** — Marries Hélène Jarislowsky. Appointed C.M.G. in the Birthday Honours.
- 1922** ● **30 Nov - 5 Dec** — The secret rescue of Prince Andrew of Greece and his family, including the infant Prince Philip, aboard HMS Calypso. **14 December** — Appointed K.C.V.O. by King George V.
- 1923** ● **12 May** — Birth of his only child, Isobel Helen Henrietta Talbot.

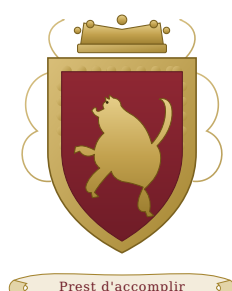
- 1923-45** ● Lives in private retirement; no further public office recorded. Civilian through the Second World War.
- 1945** ● **17 April** — Dies, aged 63.
- 1975** ● Death of his widow, Hélène, Lady Talbot.

SECTION TEN

Honours, Arms & Family Seats

Decorations & honours

HONOUR	AWARDED	FOR
O.B.E. — Officer of the Order of the British Empire	Gazetted 27 May 1919	“Valuable services as Naval Attaché in Greece”
C.M.G. — Companion of the Order of St Michael & St George	1920 Birthday Honours	Service as Naval Attaché, Athens
K.C.V.O. — Knight Commander of the Royal Victorian Order	14 December 1922	“Services rendered to Prince Andrew of Greece” — the personal gift of King George V (the source of his style “Sir”)



The arms of Talbot: Gules, a lion rampant within a bordure engrailed Or

The heraldic achievement

Arms Gules, a lion rampant within a bordure engrailed Or (a gold lion on red, within a scalloped gold border)

Origin of the arms

	Inherited from Gwenllïan ferch Rhys Mechyll, a Welsh prince's daughter who married Gilbert Talbot c. 1274
Supporters	Two white talbot hounds — the breed that shares the family name
Motto	Prest d'accomplir — "Ready to accomplish"
Family seats	Ingestre Hall, Staffordshire (the Chetwynd-Talbot branch); Alton Towers, Staffordshire (the Earls of Shrewsbury); Hensol Castle, Glamorgan (the Barons Talbot)

NOTABLE KIN

- ❖ **John Talbot, 1st Earl of Shrewsbury** (d. 1453) — "the English Achilles," Shakespeare's Talbot.
- ❖ **George Talbot, 6th Earl of Shrewsbury** — gaoler of Mary, Queen of Scots; husband of Bess of Hardwick.
- ❖ **Charles Talbot, 1st Baron Talbot** — Lord High Chancellor of Great Britain.
- ❖ **The 18th & present Earls of Shrewsbury** — Gerald's cousins; the premier earls of England.
- ❖ **Prince Philip, Duke of Edinburgh** — the infant Gerald carried to safety in 1922.

APPENDIX

Sources & Method

This dossier was compiled through a structured, multi-stage research effort, cross-checking every significant claim across independent sources and distinguishing throughout between what is documented, what is a reasonable inference, and what is family tradition. Where the record is silent or contested — Gerald's birthplace, his pre-war occupation, the precise circumstances of his death — this has been stated plainly rather than papered over.

Principal sources

GENEALOGICAL & BIOGRAPHICAL

1. thepeerage.com (entries for Sir Gerald Francis Talbot, his father, and the Talbot/Shrewsbury line), drawing on Burke's Peerage 2003. *Authoritative for dates and descent.*
2. Who Was Who, Vol. IV (1941–1950), p. 383 (entry not yet recovered in full). *The key outstanding source for his early life.*

3. The Dreadnought Project (naval career and Athens attaché succession). Specialist naval database compiled from official Navy Lists.
4. The London Gazette (O.B.E. 1919; C.M.G. 1920; K.C.V.O. 1922-23). Primary official record of honours.

THE 1922 RESCUE

1. Hugo Vickers, Alice: Princess Andrew of Greece — the fullest published account, naming Talbot. Authorised biography using family papers.
2. Philip Eade, Young Prince Philip: His Turbulent Early Life. Detailed on the rescue and the orange box.
3. The National Herald, “The Escape of Prince Andrew” & “Greek-British Relations, Nov-Dec 1922.” Narrative drawn from British diplomatic archives.
4. Kenneth Rose, King George V (on the King’s motivation). Standard authorised biography.

GREEK & INTELLIGENCE CONTEXT

1. Andrew Dalby, Eleftherios Venizelos: Greece (the “convinced Venizelist” characterisation; the 1919 Paris liaison). Scholarly biography.
2. Histories of British intelligence in WWI Greece (Compton Mackenzie’s Aegean operations). Context for the “spy” question.

FAMILY LINES

1. Wikipedia & the Dictionary of Welsh Biography / History of Parliament for the Talbot, Earl Talbot and Earl of Shrewsbury articles. Well-sourced for the documented descent.
2. americanaristocracy.com and A. M. Bradhurst, My Forefathers (1910) for the Bradhurst line; the Père-Lachaise cemetery record for the Fulda/Jarislowsky line. For the American and Bradford connections.

Open questions for future research

- ❖ His exact birthplace and baptism (1881 parish register / GRO index).
- ❖ His pre-war occupation — most likely revealed by the 1911 census and the Who Was Who entry.
- ❖ The place, cause and probate of his death in 1945 (England & Wales Probate Calendar; a Times obituary).
- ❖ Any surviving Foreign Office dispatch in which Talbot reported the 1922 mission in his own words.
- ❖ The documentary proof of one sixteenth-century link in the Talbot descent (“John of Salwarpe”).



Prepared as a private family history for Edward Hawke, May 2026. Claims are sourced to the references above; inferences and family traditions are identified as such in the text. Details of living descendants are limited to the already-published genealogical record. This document is offered as a faithful synthesis of the presently available evidence, not as the final word — the open questions above remain to be answered.